# Mary Tells Joseph / It’s Not Mine

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## CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

## SCENE 6 — MARY & JOSEPH / “IT’S NOT MINE”

### SCENE 6 — CONTINUOUS FROM SCENE 5

*No blackout.*

*The rhythm that filled the workshop has disappeared with Joseph’s friends.*

*The unfinished table remains. Joseph still wears the satchel Mary made for him.*

*Mary and Joseph are alone.*

**JOSEPH**
Mary...

*Beat.*

**JOSEPH**
What happened?

*Mary remembers Shira’s instruction: Start with the truth.*

**MARY**
I need to tell you something.

**JOSEPH**
All right.

**MARY**
I need you to listen.

**JOSEPH**
I’m listening.

**MARY**
All the way through.

*That changes him slightly.*

**JOSEPH**
Mary...

**MARY**
Please.

*Joseph nods.*

**JOSEPH**
All right.

*Mary gathers herself.*

**MARY**
I’m going to have a child.

*SILENCE*

*Joseph looks at her. For a moment the sentence does not fit anywhere in his understanding.*

**JOSEPH**
What?

**MARY**
I’m with child.

*A tiny disbelieving breath escapes him.*

**JOSEPH**
No.

**MARY**
Joseph—

**JOSEPH**
No, I mean—

*He stops. Tries again.*

**JOSEPH**
Are you certain?

**MARY**
Yes.

**JOSEPH**
Certain.

**MARY**
Yes.

*Joseph’s first instinct is not accusation. It is protection.*

**JOSEPH**
Did someone hurt you?

**MARY**
No.

**JOSEPH**
Did someone force you?

**MARY**
No.

**JOSEPH**
Are you protecting someone?

**MARY**
No.

*Joseph searches her face.*

**JOSEPH**
Then help me understand.

**MARY**
I’m trying.

**JOSEPH**
Then tell me what happened.

## THE IMPOSSIBLE EXPLANATION

**MARY**
A messenger came to me.

**JOSEPH**
A messenger.

**MARY**
From God.

*Joseph goes still.*

**JOSEPH**
Mary.

**MARY**
His name was Gabriel.

**JOSEPH**
You’re saying an angel came to you.

**MARY**
Yes.

**JOSEPH**
And told you—

**MARY**
That I would have a son.

**JOSEPH**
And the father?

**MARY**
Joseph—

**JOSEPH**
What did he say?

**MARY**
That the child comes from God.

*Joseph turns away. Not in disgust. He simply needs somewhere else to look.*

**JOSEPH**
Listen to what you’re asking me to believe.

**MARY**
I have.

**JOSEPH**
No one else saw him?

**MARY**
No.

**JOSEPH**
He came to you alone.

**MARY**
Yes.

**JOSEPH**
And then he was gone.

**MARY**
Yes.

*Joseph turns back.*

**JOSEPH**
So all I have is your word.

**MARY**
Yes.

*Beat.*

**MARY**
I know.

**JOSEPH**
You know?

**MARY**
I know exactly what that means here.

*The village outside the workshop remains ordinary and unchanged.*

## HE WANTS TO BELIEVE HER

**MARY**
You know me.

**JOSEPH**
That’s why this hurts.

*Mary takes that in.*

**MARY**
Then believe me.

**JOSEPH**
I want to.

*Beat.*

**JOSEPH**
I want to believe you.

**MARY**
Then do.

**JOSEPH**
Mary, I can’t make something make sense because I want it to.

**MARY**
It didn’t make sense to me either.

**JOSEPH**
But now it does?

**MARY**
No.

*That surprises him.*

**MARY**
Not all of it.

**JOSEPH**
Then how can you stand there and be so certain?

**MARY**
Because I know what happened to me.

**JOSEPH**
And I know what this looks like.

**MARY**
Those are not the same thing.

**JOSEPH**
They are from where I’m standing.

*Mary steps closer.*

**MARY**
Look at me.

*Joseph does.*

**MARY**
Have I ever given you a reason not to trust me?

**JOSEPH**
No.

**MARY**
Then trust me now.

*Joseph wants to. That is visible before he answers.*

**JOSEPH**
I don’t know how.

## THE TABLE

*Joseph turns away and finds the unfinished table in front of him.*

*His hand lands on it almost without thought.*

**JOSEPH**
I was building this today.

**MARY**
I know.

**JOSEPH**
Six seats.

*A small, broken breath that almost remembers the joke.*

**JOSEPH**
Maybe eight.

**MARY**
Joseph—

**JOSEPH**
The window. Your garden. That ridiculous fence I’m apparently rebuilding for the rest of my life.

*Mary’s eyes fill. These were happy things only hours ago.*

**JOSEPH**
I could see it.

**MARY**
So could I.

**JOSEPH**
I knew where the door went. Where the table went. How much room we’d need.

*He looks at her.*

**JOSEPH**
I had a plan.

**MARY**
I know.

**JOSEPH**
And now I don’t know what any of it is.

**MARY**
Neither do I.

**JOSEPH**
But you’re asking me to live inside it anyway.

**MARY**
I’m asking you to believe that I’m telling you the truth.

### THE BREAK

*Joseph searches for one final explanation.*

**JOSEPH**
Is there anything you haven’t told me?

**MARY**
No.

**JOSEPH**
Anything.

**MARY**
No.

**JOSEPH**
Something you’re afraid I won’t forgive?

**MARY**
Joseph, no.

**JOSEPH**
Because I would rather hear something terrible that I can understand than—

*He cannot finish.*

**MARY**
I don’t have an easier story to give you.

*Joseph looks at her.*

**JOSEPH**
I wish you did.

**MARY**
You think I betrayed you.

**JOSEPH**
I think something happened.

**MARY**
Something did happen.

**JOSEPH**
Something I understand.

**MARY**
That doesn’t make it true.

**JOSEPH**
And saying an angel came doesn’t make this make sense!

*His first true emotional break. Silence immediately after it.*

*Joseph regrets the volume, but not the confusion.*

**MARY**
I know.

**JOSEPH**
No, you believe.

**MARY**
Yes.

**JOSEPH**
And I don’t know how.

*His eyes drop—not accusingly, but inevitably—to the reality of the child.*

**JOSEPH**
The child...

*Beat.*

**JOSEPH**
It’s not mine.

*SILENCE*

**MARY**
No.

*Joseph closes his eyes.*

**MARY**
But that doesn’t mean—

**JOSEPH**
It’s not mine.

**MUSIC BEGINS**

**“IT’S NOT MINE”**

*The song grows directly out of Joseph attempting to restore order.*

*A fractured version of the Brotherhood rhythm appears.*

**BANG. BANG. SCRAPE. CLAP. STOMP.**

*Joseph reaches instinctively for a tool.*

**JOSEPH**
*Rhythmically*

*Measure twice...*

*He attempts the old pattern.*

**BANG. BANG.**

*Stops.*

*Nothing fits anymore.*

**VERSE 1 — WHAT HE KNOWS**

*Joseph's language stays concrete.*

*He knows*

*what they promised;*

*what they planned;*

*what he built;*

*what the evidence appears to mean.*

*The musical thought moves toward*

*I know the road.*

*I know the plan.*

*I know what should have been.*

*But this child is not mine.*

*Mary tries to reach him from inside the number.*

*She does not overpower him.*

### CHORUS — “IT’S NOT MINE”

*At first, the phrase means only*

*the child.*

*Then the meaning begins expanding.*

*It's not mine.*

*This isn't what we planned.*

*This isn't what I built.*

### VERSE 2 — THE FUTURE COLLAPSES

*The “My Beloved” motif appears underneath—distorted or incomplete.*

*Joseph looks at the table.*

*The phrase now means*

*The home I imagined isn't mine.*

*The future I understood isn't mine.*

*The story I thought I could control isn't mine.*

*Keep this section emotionally direct rather than wordy.*

## MARY'S SECTION

*Mary finally gets musical space.*

*Her territory*

*I didn't choose the fear.*

*I didn't choose the cost.*

*I didn't choose to hurt you.*

*I chose to trust God.*

*Joseph catches one word*

**JOSEPH**

*Spoken/sung*

*You chose this.*

**MARY**

*I chose to believe God.*

**JOSEPH**

*And now you're asking me to choose it too.*

### FINAL CHORUS

*The first “It's not mine” was almost an accusation.*

*The final one is loss.*

*Joseph looks at the table.*

*Then Mary.*

**JOSEPH**

*Quietly*

*It's not mine...*

*The music ends unresolved.*

*SILENCE.*

## AFTERMATH

*Mary and Joseph are now farther apart than when the scene began.*

**MARY**

Joseph...

*He cannot look at her yet.*

**MARY**

What happens now?

**JOSEPH**

I don’t know.

**MARY**

Please don’t leave.

*Joseph looks at her.*

**JOSEPH**

What would you have me do?

**MARY**

Stay.

**JOSEPH**

And pretend I understand?

**MARY**

No.

**JOSEPH**

Pretend I believe something I don’t?

**MARY**

No.

**JOSEPH**
Then what?

**MARY**
Believe me.

*Long beat.*

**JOSEPH**
I want to.

*Mary waits.*

**JOSEPH**
I don’t know how.

## JOSEPH’S CHOICE

*The anger has burned away. What remains is grief.*

**JOSEPH**
I won’t shame you.

*Mary looks at him.*

**JOSEPH**
I won’t make this public.

**MARY**
Joseph—

**JOSEPH**
Whatever people say about me, I won’t hand them something they can use against you.

**MARY**
Then don’t leave me.

*That nearly undoes him.*

**JOSEPH**
I can’t marry you.

*SILENCE*

**MARY**
You said whatever comes.

*Joseph looks at her.*

**MARY**
You said you’d walk with me.

**JOSEPH**
I know.

**MARY**
Then walk with me now.

*Joseph cannot.*

**JOSEPH**
When I said that...

*He looks at the table.*

**JOSEPH**
I thought I knew what “whatever comes” meant.

**MARY**
So did I.

*That lands differently. Neither of them planned this.*

**JOSEPH**
You still said yes.

**MARY**
Yes.

**JOSEPH**
And you believe.

**MARY**
Yes.

**JOSEPH**
I don’t.

*There is the wall between them.*

#### FINAL EXCHANGE

*Joseph moves toward the exit.*

*He passes the unfinished table and stops. His hand rests on it once. He does not destroy it, overturn it, or remove anything from it.*

**MARY**
Joseph.

*He stops.*

**MARY**
Please.

*Beat.*

**MARY**
Believe me.

*Joseph remains facing away.*

**JOSEPH**

I don’t know how.

*Joseph exits.*

*Mary remains.*

*Do not have her collapse. She is devastated, but her yes still exists.*

*Her eyes find the unfinished table. She touches the edge Joseph had been working on.*

*A nearly imperceptible fragment of “Chosen” may return not triumphant, simply present.*

*Mary steadies herself.*

*The warm workshop environment remains. Nothing outside has changed.*

**END SCENE 6**